

Year 7

Year 8

IGCSE

A-Level

I.B

ICT Fun

Forum

Homepage

Section 4.2: Types of Computers found on a network

There are two types of computers that make up a network:

- Servers
- Clients.

In this section we will discuss the features of both.

Key Concepts of this section:

- # Understand that there are **two types** of computers on a network.
- # Know the **difference** between a **server** and a **client**
- # Be able to **describe** the **features** of a server computer and a client computer.

Types of network computers

There are **two** types of **computers** that make up a **network**:

- Servers
- Clients.



Key Words:

Server, Client, Services.

Examples:



Server computers are very powerful and expensive.

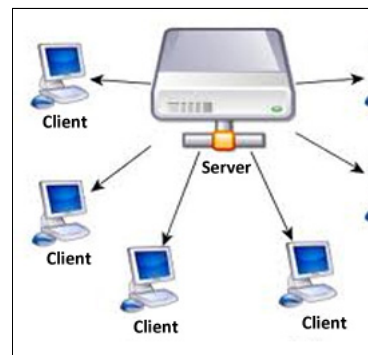
What is a server computer?

Servers are **powerful computers** that provide '**services**' to the client computers on the network.

Servers **control** the network and tell the client computers what to do.

Some services that server computers provide to client computers are summarised in the table below:

Servers provide the following services:		
Providing central storage	➔	Where all users of the network can access the same data . (like the shared: drive in a school)
Sharing devices	➔	Printers and scanners can be shared among client computers. (each client computer can access the same printer - saves money)
Providing network security	➔	The server makes sure that only people with valid usernames and passwords can log onto client computers on the network.
Sharing internet connections	➔	The same internet connection can be shared amongst client computers using a router .



Client computers are individual computers connect to a server. This forms the network.

The different types of servers:

There are different types of server computers. These are summarised in the table below:

File servers	➡	Gives network users a place to save and load their data and files .
Application servers	➡	Allow computers on the network to run and use applications and software that are stored within the server .
Printer servers	➡	Controls how printing on the network takes place. For example: the print server will create print queues to decide the order in which printing takes place.
Proxy servers	➡	Used as a kind of security device between client computers and the internet .

Note:

In order to do all of these things, servers must be very **powerful**. This is why they are much **more expensive** than **client computers**.



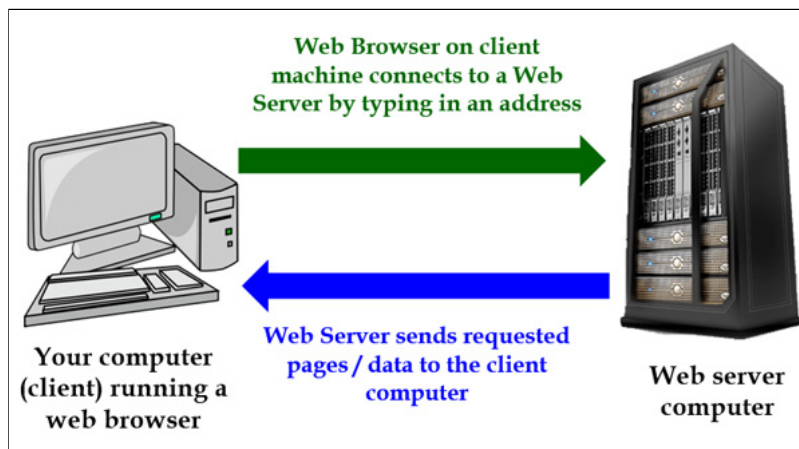
Servers allow client computers to share one p



Servers manage network security such as req usernames and passwords for people logging client computers.

What are client computers?

- # A client computer is a **normal computer** (a desktop PC or laptop for example).
- # A client computer is an **individual computer** that is used perform **everyday tasks** and to access **information** and **programs** from the **server**.
- # The image below shows how a client computer can be used to access the internet:



Client computers are everyday computers that to perform everyday tasks.

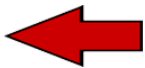


There are different types of servers - web serv example.

Activity!

[Types of Network Computers - Research Sheet](#)

Click the above task and answer the questions about the two types of network computers.



[Previous - Computer Networks Introduction](#)

[Next - Types of Networks](#)



Please add your questions/comments below:

0 Comments ictlounge

 Login ▾ Recommend 7  Share

Sort by Best ▾



Start the discussion...

Be the first to comment.

 Subscribe  Add Disqus to your site Add Disqus Add  Privacy

Links to Theory Units:

[Section 1: Types and Components of Computer Systems](#)[Section 2: Input and Output Devices](#)[Section 3: Storage Devices and](#)[Section 4: Networks and the Effects of using them](#)[Section 5: The Effects of using ICT](#)[Section 6: ICT Applications](#)[Section 7: The Systems Life Cycle](#)[Section 8: Safety and Security](#)[Section 9: Audience](#)

Section 10: Communication

Links to Practical Units:

Section 11: File Management

Section 12: Images

Section 13: layout

Section 14: Styles

Section 15: Proofing

Section 16: Graphs and Charts

Section 17: Document Production

Section 18: Data Manipulation

Section 19: Presentations

Section 20: Data Analysis

Section 21: Website Authoring

[Back to top](#)